Guitar Exercises - Section XIV, Level 98

Repertoire Adaptation

Transposition • Ensemble Roles • Acoustic/Electric Conversion • Simplification • Alternate Versions

Level 98 of the fixed 105-level core curriculum. HARD STOP after Level 105.

A learned piece is no longer treated as one fixed set of fingerings. The student must preserve musical identity while changing key, register, instrumentation, role, density, and performance environment.

Module	Exercise	Events
A	Functional transposition without shape dependence	128
B	Melody/riff transposition and register repair	128
C	Ensemble-role rearrangement	144
D	Acoustic-to-electric and electric-to-acoustic conversion	128
E	Simplification without identity loss	128
F	Density, register, and instrumentation substitution	112
G	Alternate-version arrangement design	144
H	Three 16-bar adaptation studies	216
I	Forty-eight-bar three-version repertoire capstone	336
J	Adaptation audit and mastery	64
	TOTAL	1528

Core rule: preserve function and identity; change implementation.

Reference - What Must Survive an Adaptation?

Layer	Usually preserve	May change
Form	section order/length unless intentionally rearranged	intro/outro length
Harmony	functional motion/cadences	key, voicing, extensions
Groove	identity-defining rhythmic behavior	density, register
Hook	contour/rhythm/target function	octave, fingering, articulation
Role	musical job	specific notes/grips
Expression	phrase arc	exact technique
Ending	clear resolution/cutoff behavior	voicing/register

Before adapting a piece, identify three non-negotiable identity elements. Everything else becomes a candidate for change.

Module A - Functional Transposition

Original	Function	Transpose task
C-Am-F-G	I-vi-IV-V	G, D, A, E
Dm-G7-C	ii-V-I	G, D, F, Bb major
Bm7b5-E7-Am	iiø-V-i	E, D, C minor
C-A7-Dm-G7	I-V/ii-ii-V	G and D
Am-D7-G	ii-V-I in G context	D and A destinations
F-F#dim-G	IV-#iv°-V	three new keys

Speak function first, then name new chords. Do not slide a memorized shape blindly up the neck.

Module A - Transposition Performance Ladder

Pass	Requirement
1	roots only in original key
2	Roman numerals only - no guitar
3	roots in destination key
4	triads/shells in destination key
5	performance voicings
6	same groove and section dynamics
7	memory take in new key

The transposed version must preserve phrase landmarks and cadence strength, not merely chord names.

Module B - Melody and Riff Transposition

Source pattern	Preserve	Repair if register fails
1-3-5-3	degree contour	move octave
1-b3-4-5	minor contour	change string set
5-b7-1-b3	pentatonic hook	invert register only if contour remains clear
3-2-1-7	cadential line	choose nearest voice-led position
R-5-R-b7 riff	interval identity	move pedal string or re-finger
chromatic approach -> 3	target function	respell enharmonically if needed

Transpose by scale/chord role first. Choose the fretboard route second.

Module B - Register Repair

Problem	Repair
Melody exceeds fretboard range	octave-displace one phrase boundary
Riff loses low pedal	move pedal to another string/key inversion
Open-string identity disappears	use capo/alternate voicing if available, or redesign articulation
High-register hook becomes thin	add lower dyad or octave
Bass and melody collide	separate registers, simplify inner voices
Bend target becomes impractical	choose equivalent target/register or alternate articulation

An adaptation may change fingering substantially while preserving musical behavior.

Module C - Ensemble-Role Rearrangement

Situation	Guitar role
Solo guitar	bass + harmony + melody priorities
One guitar + bass	remove unnecessary low roots
Two guitars	split rhythm/lead or low/high register
Guitar + keys	use shells/triads; avoid full-range duplication
Guitar + vocalist	leave vocal register and phrase endings clear
Power trio	increase harmonic implication without overfilling
Large ensemble	reduce density; emphasize signature landmarks

Play the same 8-bar piece in all seven roles. The part should become simpler as the ensemble becomes denser.

Module C - Two-Guitar Role Split

Pass	Guitar 1	Guitar 2
1	roots/power	upper triads
2	steady groove	fills only
3	middle shells	high counterline
4	riff	sustained harmony
5	low rhythm	octave melody
6	swap roles at section boundary	swap roles cleanly

If both guitars play the same density and register, redesign the parts rather than simply lowering volume.

Module D - Acoustic to Electric Conversion

Acoustic behavior	Electric adaptation
full open chord	partial chord/triad to reduce density
continuous strum	selected attacks + sustain
bass-strum alternation	bass may be omitted if ensemble has bass
open-string resonance	controlled sustain/muting
percussive body hit	muted string contact if musically needed
wide dynamic strum	pick attack + volume/tone control

Gain increases the cost of uncontrolled string noise. Rebuild muting before adding expressive sustain.

Module D - Electric to Acoustic Conversion

Electric behavior	Acoustic adaptation
sustained power chord	fuller voicing or repeated pulse
pinch harmonic punctuation	natural harmonic/double-stop/strong target
feedback sustain	tremolo, repeated note, or longer chord
heavy palm-mute riff	bass/chord separation or muted acoustic pulse
volume swell	rolled strum / finger attack
single-note lead over band	add bass or shell where harmony would disappear

Replace the musical function of the electric effect, not necessarily the exact sound.

Module E - Simplification without Identity Loss

Original complexity	Simplified version
7-note fill	first/last target + rhythm
full 7th/9th voicing	shell + melody note
16th ghost grid	primary pitched contacts + one ghost landmark
walking bass	roots + one approach note
compound articulation chain	single strongest articulation
two-octave riff	one-octave contour
dense chord melody	bass + melody skeleton

After simplification, ask: can a listener still identify the section and its role? If not, restore the most structural removed element.

Module E - 100/75/50/25 Percent Arrangement

Version	Content
100%	complete performance arrangement
75%	remove secondary fills/extensions
50%	groove + signature material + targets
25%	roots/shells + hook/landmarks only
Emergency	roots + section count

Perform all versions without stopping. This becomes a real-world adaptation and recovery system.

Module F - Density and Instrumentation Substitution

Missing element	Guitar may add
No bass	roots/alternating bass
No keyboard	guide tones/upper harmony
No second guitar	counterline or fuller rhythm
No percussion	more explicit rhythmic contacts
No lead instrument	melodic hook/answers
Full ensemble present	less - not more

Do not automatically fill every missing instrument. Add only what the piece needs to remain coherent.

Module F - Register Substitution

Source role	Alternate register treatment
low riff	middle octave + bass left open
high triad comp	middle shell
middle melody	octave up for chorus lift
bass-led solo guitar	upper bass inversion if low register unavailable
wide chord	split attack: bass then upper voices
high climax	low-register release afterward

Register is arrangement, not merely fretboard convenience.

Module G - Alternate-Version Design

Version	Constraint
Acoustic	no gain-dependent technique
Electric	reduced chord density, stronger sustain/muting
Trio	guitar carries more harmonic implication
Large ensemble	guitar carries less
Half-time	same form/harmony; groove reinterpreted
Sparse	maximum 2 meaningful attacks/bar
Instrumental	vocal hook transferred to guitar
Vocal-support	lead content reduced around vocal phrases

Create two alternate versions of one learned piece. Each version must have a written reason for every major change.

Module H - Study 1 - Transposition

16-bar I-vi-IV-V / ii-V-I piece in C.

Transpose to E. Preserve hook degrees, groove, dynamics, and ending; redesign voicings.

Pass	Deliverable
1	identity elements
2	functional map
3	adapted skeleton
4	adapted groove/voicing
5	performance version
6	25% fallback version

Module H - Study 2 - Ensemble role

16-bar A-minor piece with bass-heavy guitar part.

Create solo-guitar, trio, and full-band guitar versions.

Pass	Deliverable
1	identity elements
2	functional map
3	adapted skeleton
4	adapted groove/voicing
5	performance version
6	25% fallback version

Module H - Study 3 - Acoustic/electric

16-bar riff-and-chorus piece.

Build acoustic and electric versions that preserve riff identity and chorus lift without copying unavailable effects.

Pass	Deliverable
1	identity elements
2	functional map
3	adapted skeleton
4	adapted groove/voicing
5	performance version
6	25% fallback version

Module I - Forty-Eight-Bar Three-Version Capstone

Bars	Section	Harmony	Baseline role
1-8	A	Cmaj7-Am7-Dm7-G7 x2	original arrangement
9-16	B	Am7-Dm7-E7-Am7 x2	original contrast
17-24	A'	Cmaj7-A7-Dm7-G7 x2	original development
25-32	C	Gmaj7-Em7-Am7-D7 x2	original modulation
33-40	Solo/return	Dm7-G7-Cmaj7-A7 x2	original role change
41-48	Outro	Cmaj7-Fmaj7-G7-Cmaj7 x2	original ending

Create and perform THREE complete versions of this same 48-bar piece: (1) solo/acoustic, (2) electric trio, (3) full-band support. Preserve form, functional harmony, signature hook, and ending identity while changing implementation.

Module J - Adaptation Audit

Category	0	1	2
Identity preservation	lost	partial	clear
Transposition	shape-dependent errors	functional	fluent
Role awareness	collides	usable	ensemble-aware
Acoustic/electric conversion	literal/awkward	functional	musical
Simplification	identity lost	mostly	structural
Register/density	poor	usable	intentional
Alternate versions	cosmetic	different	purpose-built
Recovery	restart	simplifies	seamless

Pass Level 98: 14/16 or better on two separate days, with no zero in identity preservation, transposition, role awareness, or recovery.

Next: Level 99 completes Section XIV with repertoire-set construction: multiple complete pieces, sequencing, between-song transitions, endurance, gear/patch discipline, memory recovery, and a short live-set capstone.